

Swapped at Birth

(adapted from <http://www.mirror.co.uk/news/world-news/families-babies-mistakenly-swapped-birth-5137525>)

The families of two babies who were swapped at birth were awarded almost €2 million (£1.5million) in compensation in February of this year.

The clinic responsible for the switch was ordered to pay €400,000 to each of the babies swapped, €300,000 euros to three parents concerned and €60,000 to three siblings as part of a €1.88 million (£1.4million) settlement.

On July 4 1994 Sophie Serrano, **had given** birth to a girl at a clinic in Cannes, France. Her daughter Manon, who was suffering from jaundice, was put in an incubator next to another new-born girl with the same condition.

When Manon was returned to Sophie, she complained to nurses that her daughter's skin was too dark but she was told incubator lamps were to blame and she was sent home.



Three years later, Manon's hair **had grown** curly and her skin olive-toned - unlike either parent. Her father decided to separate from Ms Serrano after village rumours **had spread** about the young girl being "the postman's daughter".

In 2004, DNA tests showed Manon was the daughter of

neither of them. An investigation was launched and Sophie's biological child was located less than 20 miles away.

The investigation found that when the babies were returned to their mothers in the hospital, an auxiliary nurse **had accidentally exchanged** the two female babies.

Both girls met their biological parents in 2005 but they did not ask to be switched back.

The two families have distanced themselves from each other since the meeting ten years ago. Sophie Serrano said in December last year: "It's too difficult, so we each went our separate ways as it's so distressing."

Read the beginning and end of this true story. Can you predict what had happened?

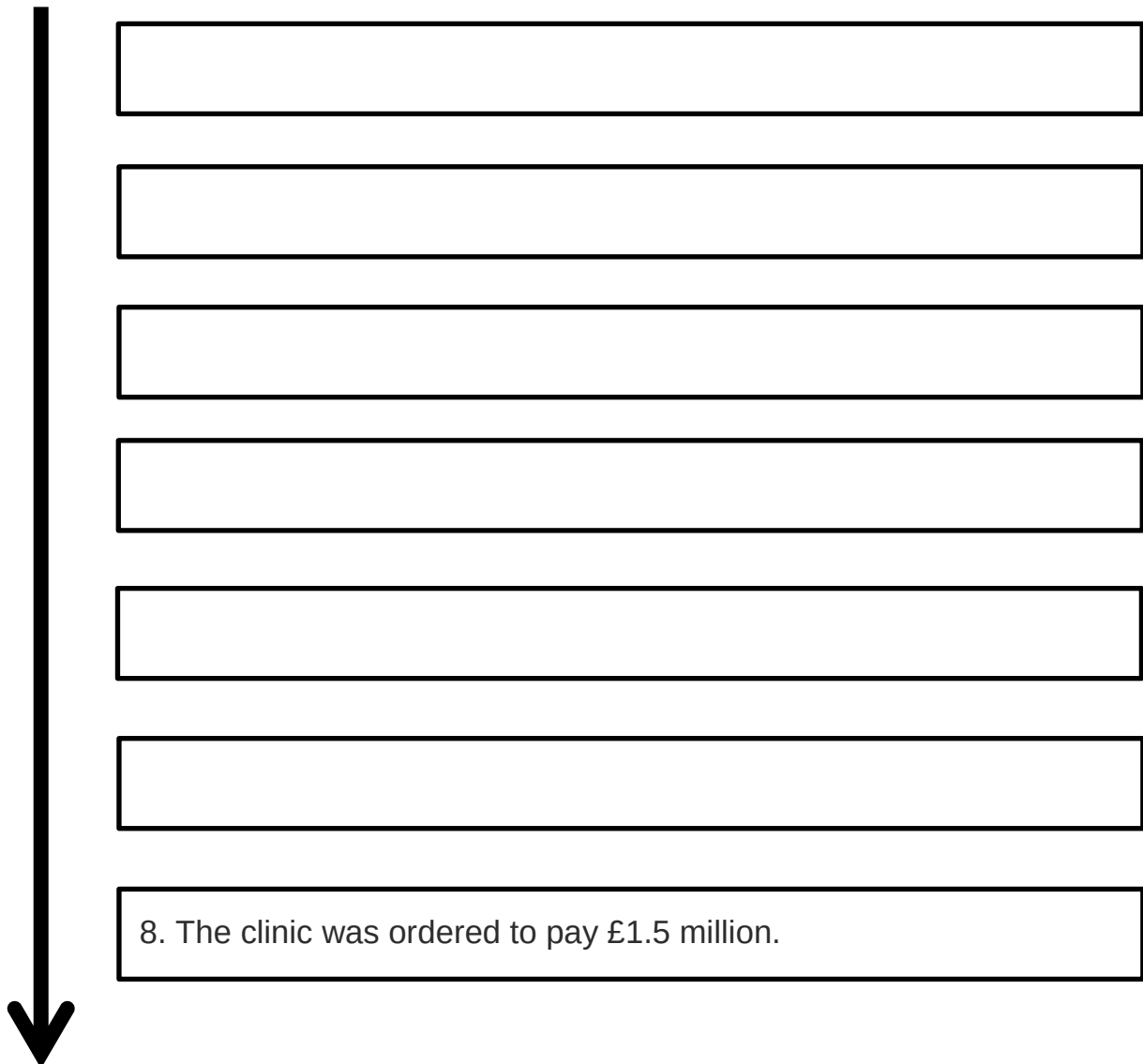
On July 4 1994, Sophie Serrano gave birth to her first child, a baby daughter, at a clinic in the south of France. She named her daughter Manon and was exhausted after giving birth to her first child at the age of 18. Manon was taken away because she was suffering from jaundice. A nurse's assistant took care of Manon and put her in an incubator to recover.

Four days later, Sophie was happy to be reunited with her daughter. However, she was confused about the length of her daughter's hair. Manon's hair was longer than she had remembered. The staff at the hospital told Sophie not to worry and that the lights in the incubator had caused Manon's hair to grow more quickly. Despite Sophie's concerns, she was sent home.

Almost twenty years later, Sophie and her now grown up daughter Manon exited a court in France after many years of heartache and struggle.

**Put the events of the story listed below in the correct order on the timeline.
One has already been done as an example.**

- ~~The clinic was ordered to pay £1.5 million.~~
- The nurse's assistant accidentally exchanged to two babies.
- Manon's hair grew curly.
- Sophie Serrano gave birth to a daughter.
- Manon's father decided to separate from Sophie.
- Both girls met their biological parents.
- Village rumours spread about Manon and her parents.
- The babies were returned to their mothers.



Timeline structure:

- Empty box
- Empty box
- Empty box
- Empty box
- Empty box
- Empty box
- 8. The clinic was ordered to pay £1.5 million.